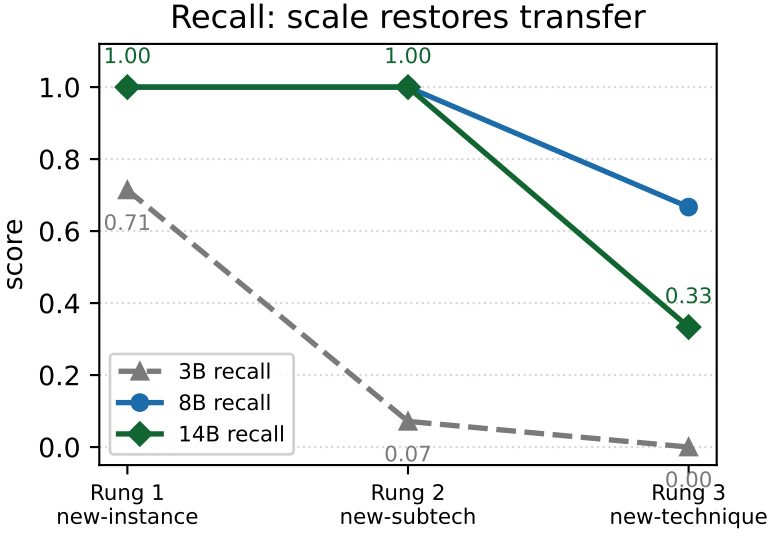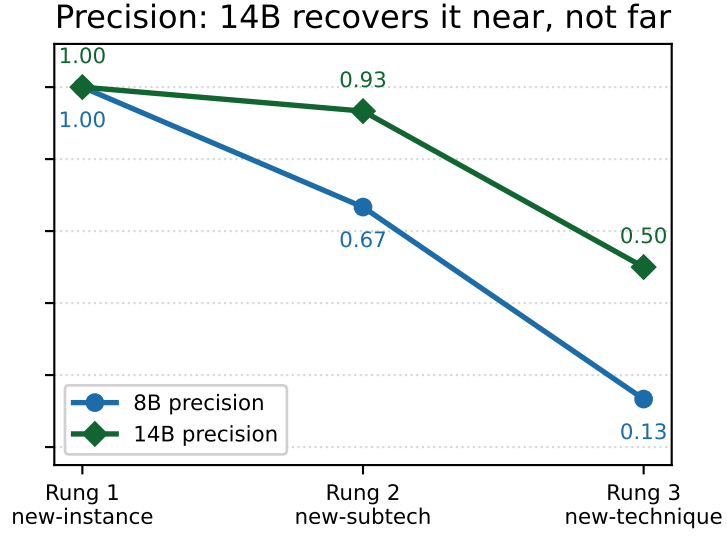Down the ladder (3B → 8B → 14B): recall rises with scale, precision pays with distance